ONE MEASURED RUN · FICTIONAL SAMPLE ORG · ZOHO CRM V8 API

What the kit found in a three-year-old CRM, and what it fixed

Brightwater Supply Co. is invented: 5,776 records, 7 users (one deactivated), 16 workflow rules, Professional edition. Problems were planted on purpose so the results can be scored. The kit read the org, wrote a plan, and applied it through the API.

192
duplicates merged, 0 wrong; 40 groups held for review

25 → 11
Lead Source values

453
records moved off a deactivated user

6,727
record updates, 0 errors; second run: 0 left

897
API credits, 6.9% of the daily allowance

Findings, before and after

	BEFORE	AFTER	FINDING
HIGH	461	0 ✓	Records owned by deactivated users
HIGH	190	31	Duplicate leads
HIGH	42	9	Duplicate contacts
HIGH	12	0 ✓	Lead Source split across spelling variants
MEDIUM	5,880	0 ✓	Phone numbers in mixed formats
MEDIUM	17	0 ✓	Deals in stages that are no longer in the pipeline
HIGH	136	136	Open deals past their closing date
MEDIUM	108	108	Leads that are already contacts
HIGH	2	2	Rules that email on every single edit
HIGH	1	1	Active workflow rules that do the same thing twice
MEDIUM	5	5	Custom fields filled on under 2% of records

Overdue deals and leads-that-are-contacts are flagged for the owners, not changed: those need a person.

Duplicates: not merging the wrong people

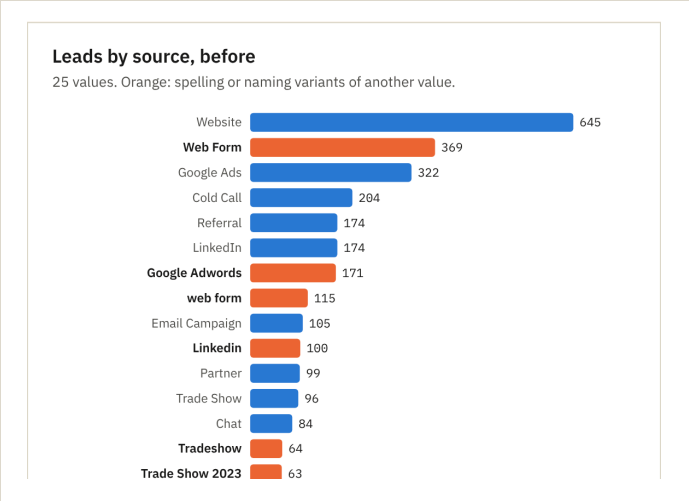
METHOD	REAL	FOUND	WRONG PAIRS
Exact text match	52%	47%	93
Any one field	8%	97%	2,265
This kit	**96%**	**93%**	**9**

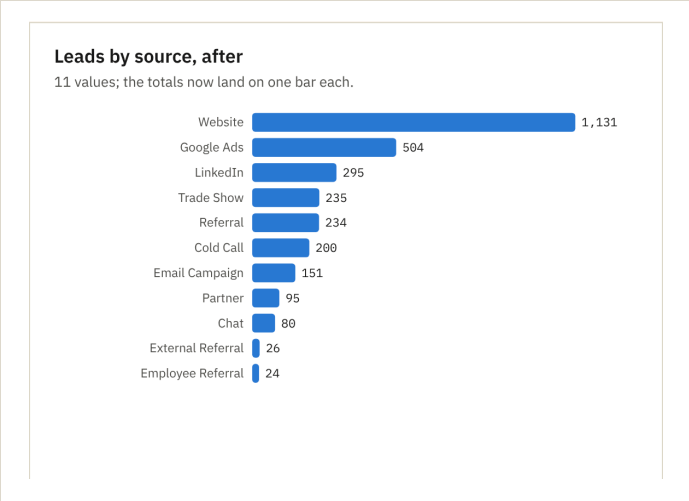
Rules: same personal email; or same phone and names that agree; or same company and names that agree. A shared switchboard never counts. When two personal emails disagree, the group waits for a person: all 9 wrong pairs (namesakes at one company) were stopped there.

HELD FOR REVIEW same phone + names agree

	NAME	EMAIL	PHONE	COMPANY
keep	Brian White	brian.white@pinecresthosp…	404-555-9412	Pinecrest Hospitality Corp.
merge in	Brian White	bwhite@pinecresthospitali…	404.555.9412	Pinecrest Hospitality Corp.

Two different people with the same name at one company. The rules matched them; the different emails stopped the merge.

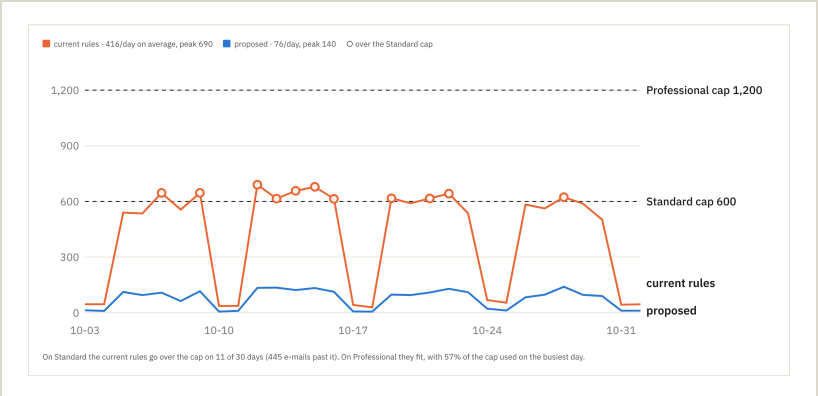




WORKFLOWS

Every edition caps workflow e-mails per user licence, per day

The sample's rules replayed against 30 days of activity. Two rules that mail on every edit plus one rule copied twice send most of the volume: on Standard (100 per licence) that goes over the cap on 11 of 30 days. The proposed set averages 76 a day.



Edition limits that shape a redesign

	STD	PRO	ENT
Custom fields / module	10	155	300
Page layouts / module	—	1	3
Active rules / module	15	40	75
Workflow e-mails / licence / day	100	200	500
Validation rules / layout	—	5	10
Unique fields / module	2	2	2
Blueprints	—	3	50

Zoho feature comparison, November 2026. — = not available.

HOW IT RUNS

Read first, change second, everything written down

1. **Snapshot** with read-only scopes: users, fields, pipeline, workflow rules with their criteria and actions, every record. 43 calls / 43 credits here.
2. **Audit** offline: 23 checks, re-runnable for free.
3. **Plan** as a JSON file you can read. Business decisions (which sources are the same, who takes a leaver's records) live in small mapping files.
4. **Dry run**: every request and its credit cost (854 estimated = 854 charged).
5. **Apply** with a journal of before-values; **rollback** restores them. Merges can't be undone via the API, so uncertain groups wait for approval.

DOCUMENTATION

The register writes itself from the API

Every field with type and fill rate, the pipeline, every workflow rule with trigger, criteria and actions, and a log of applied changes, regenerated after each change. Settings the API should not touch become a 15-step checklist with where to find each one: removing picklist options, retiring 5 near-empty fields after export, switching off the noisy and duplicate rules, Email duplicate check on web forms, an assignment rule for new leads, a required loss reason.

Checked: tests 17, pass 17, fail 0, covering matching, picklists, credit maths, paging past 2,000 records, API limits, apply and rollback.

Measured

One run against a mock of the Zoho CRM v8 API that follows the documented endpoints, response shapes, paging, merge and update limits and credit costs. Scores are counted against the problems planted in the sample.

Not measured

Your org: the sample and the rules share an author, so scores show the rules work on these patterns, not a promise for your data; every merge group is listed for approval first. Live API speed. The e-mail activity log is generated.